

Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ J 10 8 2
♥ J 10 2
♦ Q 10 5
♣ J 8 2

♠ K 7 5
♥ Q 9 6
♦ A 9 8 3
♣ A Q 7



♠ 9 4 3
♥ A 8 5 4
♦ J 7 4 2
♣ 9 4

♠ A Q 6
♥ K 7 3
♦ K 6
♣ K 10 6 5 3

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	4NT
All Pass			
4NT by North			

Yes, this has nothing to do with Gerber or Blackwood, but everything to do with smart bidding.

SOUTH has a 16 points and NORTH has 15, 16 or 17. SOUTH wants to be in 6NT if NORTH has 17, but merely a Notrump game if she has 15 or 16.

The way to find out is to bid 4NT - not Blackwood but merely an invitation to bid 6NT. In this case, NORTH has but 15 points and declines the invitation. If her ♥Q were changed to the ♥A she would bid 6NT and collect her twelve easy tricks.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K Q J 4

♥ K 6

♦ K 4

♣ K Q J 10 5

♠ 9 2

♥ 10 9 8 5

♦ 8 7 6 5

♣ 7 6 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 8 7 6

♥ Q J 7

♦ A J 3

♣ A 8 2

♠ 10 5 3

♥ A 4 3 2

♦ Q 10 9 2

♣ 9 3

*West**North**East**South*

4♣

Pass

4NT

Pass

6NT

All Pass

6NT by East

When EAST opens 1NT WEST hopes his hand includes all four Aces so she can bid 7NT. So she uses Gerber to find out.

But, when she discovers they are missing an Ace she settles for 6NT.